

GUI vs CLI

When comparing GUI and CLI, the two main things you are gaining and sacrificing are convenience and flexibility. When you use a GUI, you get the convenience of nice and organized buttons, inputs and outputs, and nice colors to look at. But you sacrifice flexibility since it's a lot harder to implement a feature to a GUI while keeping it looking good and making sense and, as such, there will tend to be fewer features. On the other hand, when using a CLI, you get a cold and bleak text prompt with little to no decoration or instruction (besides documentation). But because there is that lack of decor it is much easier to make tools for a CLI since you don't have the burden of graphics, and the CLI isn't limited to running one tool like a GUI is specialized to its single program with only some possible interconnectivity given by the creator. With a CLI, you can have as many tools as you want and are available. Another benefit to using a CLI is that they are more widely supported across operating systems. For example, I run Arch Linux and so when I was asked to install GitHub Desktop I couldn't. I ended up having to use the GitHub CLI to connect to my repo since it was supported on more operating systems